

Since its announcement at the Google I/O conference on May 19, 2010, the Chrome Web Store has attracted developers and users alike. Released on December 6, 2010, the Chrome Web Store is an online marketplace that gives you access to thousands of web apps that can help the more than 160 million chrome users customise their browsing experience. All you need to do is install web apps from the Chrome Web Store.

## What are web apps?

Over the years, web sites have evolved from pages of static content to interactive applications that are similar to software you'd normally install from a CD. A good example of a web app is Gmail. Gmail provides you with the functionality you'd normally expect to get from a desktop app but it comes with all the benefits of web apps. For example, you don't need to manually update Gmail—you always have the most up-to-date version. And if you use multiple devices to email—for example, a work and a personal computer or even a phone—you don't have to reinstall it every time; you just need to fire up your browser.

Most web browsers make no distinction between apps and web pages. Google Chrome is different in this regard as it supports the concept of installable web apps. An installable web app can be a normal website with a bit of extra metadata; this type of app is called a hosted app. Alternatively, an installable web app can bundle all its content into an archive that users download when they install the app; this is a packaged app.



**Web Store:**  
Enhance your  
Chrome experience  
with Apps from the  
Chrome Web Store